to give any assistance to the agency that aids survivors in the southern kibbutzim because they were among those active in the protests.

And in a recent public declaration Smotrich took responsibility for “what was” and admitted that “the country’s leadership failed to protect the country’s people.” As well as being the finance minister, he is also minister in the defense ministry and therefore in charge of settlers and settlements. He didn’t apologize for hastening the building of settlements by all possible means. There is more: while the minister of education wants to use the money allocated to religious schools to help schoolchildren from the South, Smotrich is opposing it. Words of apology are easily provided, but changes of policy are nowhere to be seen among the most fanatical members of the coalition. As for Ben-Gvir, he has remained mostly silent since the attack.

In the meantime, Iran’s foreign minister is touring some of the region’s Muslim countries, and in each capital he threatens Israel with more dire consequences if it does not stop its “genocide of Palestinians” in Gaza. As for Iran’s supreme leader, Ali Khamenei, he kissed the hands of Hamas’s leaders for the defeat they inflicted on Israel. For the time being, apart from its uncertain involvement in the preparations of the attack, Iran seems to be generous mainly with words, probably due to America’s unequivocal support of Israel. It could be that the intensification of Israel’s fighting with Hezbollah on the Lebanese border will compel it to intervene.

Monday, October 16

Today the Knesset reconvened for its winter session. None of the main speakers (Herzog, Netanyahu, Lapid) said anything beyond the typical generalities. The session was interrupted by an alert but resumed shortly thereafter. It is to be noted that neither Netanyahu nor Defense Minister Gallant said a word about their responsibility in this catastrophe. Do they really hope to escape an immediate verdict as well as the verdict of history?